

Stay in Business

Protect Your Firm with Redundant Backup Systems

December 14, 2007

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Summary

Essential Backup Systems

Incidents and Recovery Sources

Best Practices and Key Points

Time Matters Backups and Synchronization

E-mail and Attachment Bloat

Every Day Backup for Time Matters

A Utility by Wells H Anderson – Now in Beta

Essential Backup Systems

It is best to employ all of these systems but three or more are essential. They are listed in order of importance. Some require little or no cost for software. I am available to assist you with selection, implementation and instruction.

- 1. Full Data Off Site**
- 2. Full Data On Site - SyncBack**
- 3. Selected Data via Internet Service – Connected.com**
- 4. Independent Database Backup**
- 5. Full Hard Drive Bare Metal Restore System**
- 6. RAID System for Network Drives**
- 7. Synchronized Live Database On Site**
- 8. Optional: Synchronized Off Site Server**

Incidents and Recovery Sources

Incident	Best Source	Next Best	Last Resort
Document or file overwritten or deleted (User error, virus, Word or Windows crash)	On site file backup	Internet backup	Off site backup
Database record(s) deleted, overwritten or corrupted (User error, software failure)	TM Recycle Bin or synced clone database on office PC.	SQL backup file restored to TM Tutor database	Backup TM Main SQL database. Restore older version of Main database to retrieve record(s). Restore current version.
Disk drive failure	RAID system	Temporary: Synced office PC. Permanent: Replace drive. Restore from image.	Replace drive. Reinstall system and application software. Restore from on site or off site backup.
Office disaster (Fire, sprinkler, theft, storm, earthquake)	Live, off site duplicate server	Temporary: Synced notebook Permanent: New server restored from on or off site image backups	New server. Acquire and reinstall system and application software. Restore data from on or off site full backup.
Major disaster. (Office and off site backups destroyed)	Temporary: Synced notebooks	Internet Backup Service – select data	

Best Practices and Key Points

Complacency

It is human nature to pay attention to immediate responsibilities and defer attention to unlikely and speculative problems.

Redundancy

Any single backup system can fail.

Multiple Backup Versions

Some data losses may be discovered days or weeks after they occur.

Fast, Simple Recovery

If a recovery method is too time-consuming it may be impractical to use in light of the value of the data.

Immediate Access during Temporary Outage

On-site synchronized systems can allow people to continue working when the network or server is down.

Full Hard Drive Bare Metal Restore System

The corruption of the Windows operating system on a PC or network server can cause a great deal of lost time.

Scheduled Tests of Data Recovery

The most widespread violation of important disaster recovery practices is the failure to perform regular tests of restoring data.

How to Restore Lost Data and Computers

The best method of preventing or restoring lost data is listed first below each problem.



Time Matters Backup

Daily Backups

Network Backup – Not sufficient for Enterprise Edition

Time Matters Backup – Manual, 7-Day Rotation

Automatic Backups

Professional Edition – Third party software needed

Enterprise Edition – Setup by a CIC or network engineer

Synchronization with a Remote Database

An immediately available cloned database

Stand-alone database on a notebook or home PC

Time Matters E-mail and Attachment Bloat

Problems:

Contribute to large database and backup size

Create a risk of corruption that threatens all Attachments

Solutions:

Follow best practices for E-mail – See:

<http://www.activepractice.com/1234tips/inboxsettings>

Save Attachments as Time Matters documents and delete from E-mails
See:

For Enterprise Edition, TMTTools from www.tmttools.net

Q and A

Enterprise Backup File Location for MSDE
c:\windows\system32*.bak

SyncBack -

<http://www.2brightsparks.com/syncback/syncback-hub.html>

WinZip - <http://www.winzip.com>

Acronis TrueImage - <http://www.acronis.com>

APC Uninterruptible Power Supply -

<http://www.apc.com/products/category.cfm?id=13&subid=5>

Every Day Backup

A utility program by Wells H Anderson

Automated daily backups for Professional or Enterprise

Automated periodic synchronization for Professional or Enterprise

Scheduled for release Q1 2008

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